

Classroom SEL pack, a week on managing anger, ages 3 to 7

The Desert Buzz

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Desert breath	Hold a feather in front of your mouth. Breathe in slowly, then breathe out so gently the feather only wiggles. Do it three times. Use it whenever someone needs to cool do…	Page 8
Day 5 The tower falls	The tower falls, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Belonging and Contributing, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a tray of sand or blocks, a feather or a paper fan, a feelings thermometer drawing

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: Who are these two friends? Where do they live? Ask: What makes you feel angry? What does angry feel like in your body? Take a few answers. Practise the desert breath: breathe in slowly through your nose like smelling a flower, then out slowly like a soft desert breeze.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Etoo and Bella explore the desert together.	What do Etoo and Bella like to do together?	climb cactus, share nectar, rest under rocks
5	Bella's wings knock down the tower.	Why did Etoo get so angry?	his tower fell, he worked hard on it
6	'I didn't mean to!'	Was it Bella's fault?	no, it was an accident, the wind from her wings
7	'You always ruin everything!'	Was it fair when Etoo said Bella always ruins everything? Why or why not?	no, it was one accident, it was hurtful
8	Bella flies off, her wings drooping.	How do you think Bella felt when Etoo stomped away?	hurt, sad, lonely
10	Being angry isn't making Etoo feel better.	What does Etoo notice now?	he misses Bella, it's empty, being angry doesn't help
11	Etoo takes a deep breath.	What helped Etoo calm down?	a deep breath, the scorpion's words
14	Both friends say sorry.	Why do you think Bella said sorry too?	she didn't want to upset him, she cares about him

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Feeling angry is okay. The message is about what we do with the feeling, never that anger is bad. More notes on the "For every child" page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

angry

a hot, big feeling when something seems unfair

Do it: make fists and scrunch your face

accident

something that happens by mistake, not on purpose

Do it: shrug with open hands

stomp

to walk hard and loud with your feet

Do it: stomp twice

breath

the air you take in and let out

Do it: breathe in slowly, then out

calm

quiet and still inside

Do it: press your hands down gently

Managing anger

The value in this book.

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When anger buzzes loud, pause and listen to your heart.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



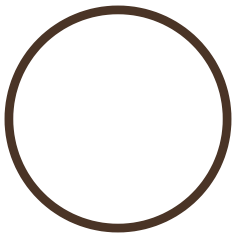
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



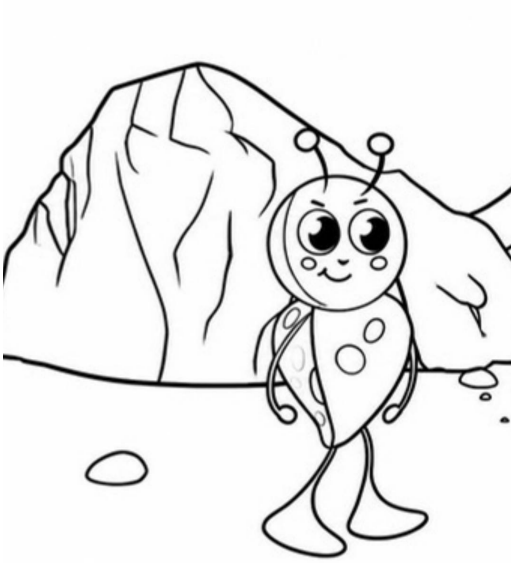
something else

clip your name here

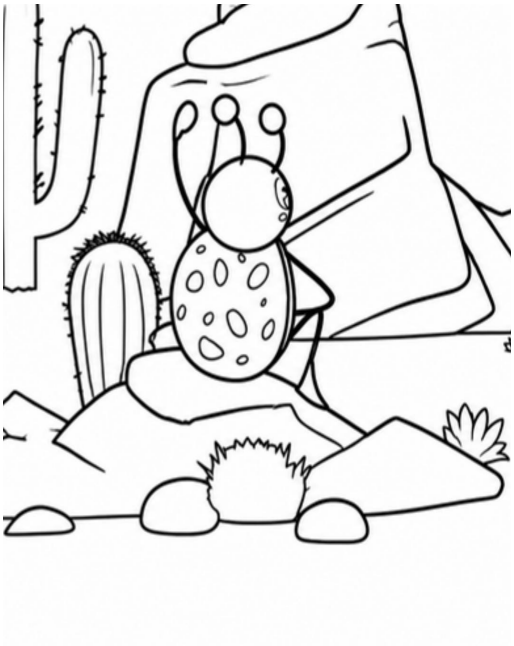
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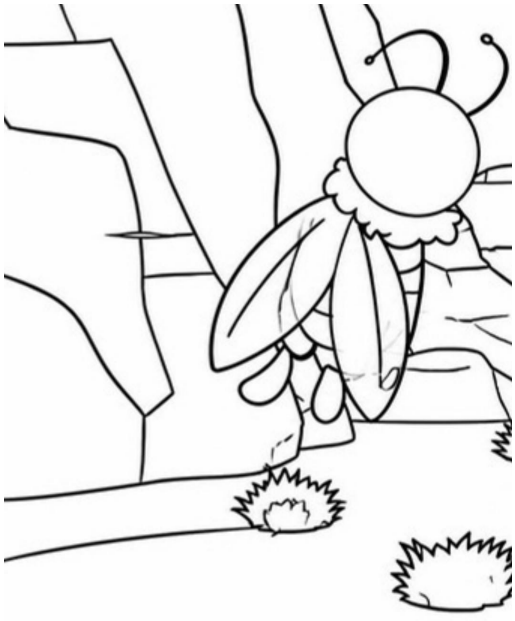
Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Desert breath

5 minutes, any time, Whole class, Materials: A feather or a paper fan

Hold a feather in front of your mouth. Breathe in slowly, then breathe out so gently the feather only wiggles. Do it three times. Use it whenever someone needs to cool down.

The tower falls

15 minutes, Small groups, Materials: Sand tray or blocks

Build a tower. A grown-up gently knocks it down ‘by accident’. Children practise: stop, breathe, say how they feel (‘I feel angry because…’), then rebuild it together.

Anger thermometer

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A big drawing of a thermometer

Mark ‘a little cross’ at the bottom and ‘buzzing loud’ at the top. Children place a sticker where Etoo was at each part of the story, and talk about what helps the feeling go back down.

Science and nature corner

Many kinds of beetles and bees live in hot deserts. Desert beetles often hide under rocks or in sand during the hottest part of the day to stay cool. Bees visit desert flowers like cactus blossoms to drink nectar and help plants make seeds. Scorpions are desert hunters that come out at night. Never touch or pick up scorpions, bees or beetles in the wild.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Etoo get so angry?

Look for: His sand tower got knocked down.

2. Was it fair when Etoo said Bella always ruins everything?

Look for: No. It was one accident, and the words hurt her.

3. How do you think Bella felt when Etoo stomped away?

Look for: Hurt and sad. Accept any feeling word.

4. What helped Etoo calm down?

Look for: A slow, deep breath and remembering the scorpion's advice.

5. What helps you when you feel a big angry feeling?

Look for: Any answer. Practise the slow breath together.



The big line

"When anger buzzes loud, pause and listen to your heart."

The big idea: It's okay to feel angry. When anger gets big, stop, take a deep breath and listen to your heart before you act.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show managing anger this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show managing anger by

Name _____



I can show managing anger by

Name _____



I can show managing anger by

Name _____



I can show managing anger by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Belonging and Contributing	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book's desert has no name, but its tall cactuses look like saguaros, so we picked Saguaro National Park in Arizona. Pinacate beetles and desert hairy scorpions live in this desert.



Pinacate beetle

Because of its headstand, people also call it the clown beetle or the stink beetle.



Honey bee

Honey bees can taste with their feet!



Giant desert hairy scorpion

It's the largest scorpion in North America.

Saguaro National Park, Arizona

Etoo: The book doesn't name Etoo's kind of beetle, so we picked the pinacate beetle, a small black desert beetle. When it gets upset it does a headstand and sprays, so it knows all about big feelings!

Bella: Bella's gust of wind knocking over a sand tower is a story idea, since a real bee is far too small! Worker honey bees really are all girls, like Bella.

The wise old scorpion: The book's scorpion is purple and wise. Real desert hairy scorpions are yellow with a dark back, and they're not famous for advice, but they can live for years, so 'old' fits!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-desert-buzz

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Use face cards for angry, sad, calm and happy. Teach ‘I feel angry because…’ as a sentence starter.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 5, 8 and 11). This book has 17 spreads with short text on each, so it reads quickly.

Children with big feelings

Practise the desert breath when everyone is calm, so it’s ready when it’s needed. Offer a calm corner, and never shame a child for feeling angry.

Handle with care

Feeling angry is okay. The message is about what we do with the feeling, never that anger is bad.

This guide is not therapy. If a child has frequent or very intense outbursts, talk with their family and your school team.

Bella did nothing wrong. Keep the accident clear so no child feels blamed for accidents.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. Many traditions teach the same simple tool: when you feel a big angry feeling, wait and breathe before you speak or act.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Desert Buzz, a story about managing anger. Etoo the beetle gets very angry at his friend Bella over an accident, then learns that a slow, deep breath helps him calm down and say sorry. At home, practise the 'desert breath' together when everyone is calm: in slowly like smelling a flower, out slowly like a soft breeze. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Bourdonnement du désert, une histoire sur la gestion de la colère. Etoo le scarabée se fâche très fort contre son amie Bella à cause d'un accident, puis découvre qu'une respiration lente et profonde l'aide à se calmer et à s'excuser. À la maison, pratiquez ensemble la « respiration du désert » quand tout le monde est calme : on inspire lentement comme pour sentir une fleur, on souffle doucement comme une brise. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre cómo manejar el enojo. Etoo, el escarabajo, se enoja mucho con su amiga Bella por un accidente, y aprende que una respiración lenta y profunda lo ayuda a calmarse y pedir perdón. En casa, practiquen juntos la «respiración del desierto» cuando todos estén tranquilos: inspirar despacio como oliendo una flor, soltar despacio como una brisa suave. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über den Umgang mit Wut gelesen. Der Käfer Etoo wird wegen eines Missgeschicks sehr wütend auf seine Freundin Bella und lernt dann, dass ein langsamer, tiefer Atemzug ihm hilft, sich zu beruhigen und sich zu entschuldigen. Üben Sie zu Hause gemeinsam den ‚Wüstenatem', wenn alle ruhig sind: langsam einatmen wie an einer Blume riechen, langsam ausatmen wie eine sanfte Brise. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia su come gestire la rabbia. Etoo, lo scarabeo, si arrabbia moltissimo con la sua amica Bella per un incidente, poi scopre che un respiro lento e profondo lo aiuta a calmarsi e a chiedere scusa. A casa, esercitatevi insieme nel «respiro del deserto» quando tutti sono tranquilli: inspirare piano come annusando un fiore, espirare piano come una brezza leggera. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Managing anger: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Managing anger: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Managing anger: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Managing anger: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Desert Buzz

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: managing anger.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

It's okay to feel angry. When anger gets big, stop, take a deep breath and listen to your heart before you act.

The big line

"When anger buzzes loud, pause and listen to your heart."

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
angry	a hot, big feeling when something seems unfair	make fists and scrunch your face
accident	something that happens by mistake, not on purpose	shrug with open hands
stomp	to walk hard and loud with your feet	stomp twice
breath	the air you take in and let out	breathe in slowly, then out
calm	quiet and still inside	press your hands down gently

A gentle note

Feeling angry is okay. The message is about what we do with the feeling, never that anger is bad.

This guide is not therapy. If a child has frequent or very intense outbursts, talk with their family and your school team.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Etoo

Pinacate beetle

A tiny beetle learning to calm his big anger



Bella

Honey bee

Etoo's best friend, who buzzes from flower to flower



The wise old scorpion

Giant desert hairy scorpion

Gives Etoo good advice

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How did they feel?

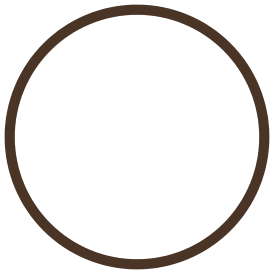
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Etoo and Bella explore the desert together.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

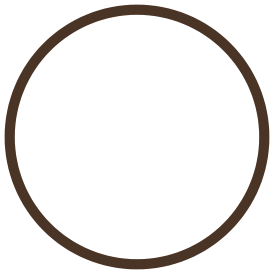


Moment 2

Bella flies off, her wings drooping.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

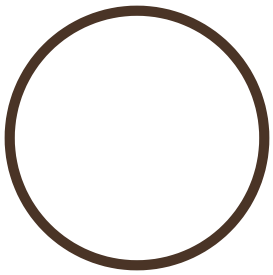


Moment 3

Both friends say sorry.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



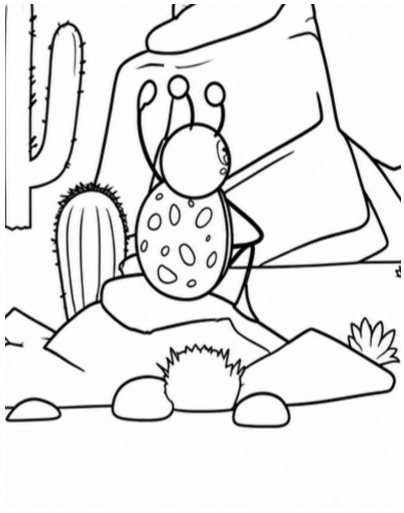
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Story in order

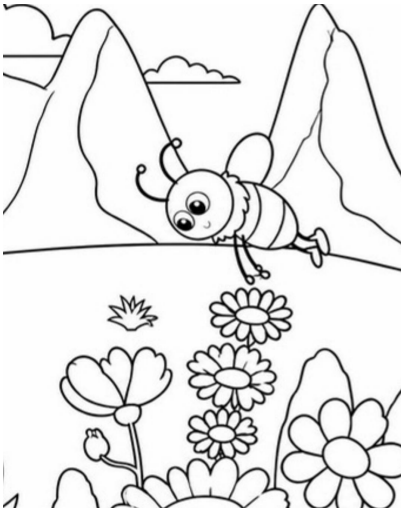
Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

angry a hot, big feeling when something seems unfair

angry angry

accident something that happens by mistake, not on purpose

accident accident

stomp to walk hard and loud with your feet

stomp stomp

Etoo the hero of the story

Etoo Etoo

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Etoo showed managing anger. Draw a time when you showed managing anger too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

The tower falls

You need: Sand tray or blocks

Build a tower. A grown-up gently knocks it down ‘by accident’. Children practise: stop, breathe, say how they feel (‘I feel angry because…’), then rebuild it together.

Desert breeze breath

When you feel angry, breathe in slowly, then blow out like a soft desert breeze. Try it three times.

Waggle dance

Hide a toy, then do a dance to show where it is. Can your family find it?

Sand tower

Build a tower with blocks or sand. If it falls, what can you say or do?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Desert Buzz are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Etoo

Pinacate beetle

Because of its headstand, people also call it the clown beetle or the stink beetle.



Bella

Honey bee

Honey bees can taste with their feet!



The wise old scorpion

Giant desert hairy scorpion

It's the largest scorpion in North America.

Story or real?

The book doesn't name Etoo's kind of beetle, so we picked the pinacate beetle, a small black desert beetle. When it gets upset it does a headstand and sprays, so it knows all about big feelings!

Where they really live

The book's desert has no name, but its tall cactuses look like saguaros, so we picked Saguaro National Park in Arizona. Pinacate beetles and desert hairy scorpions live in this desert.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-desert-buzz

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

Who are these two friends? Where do they live?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 1

Why did Etoo get so angry?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 2

Was it fair when Etoo said Bella always ruins everything?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 3

How do you think Bella felt when Etoo stomped away?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 4

What helped Etoo calm down?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 5

What helps you when you feel a big angry feeling?

The Desert Buzz, talk card 6

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Managing anger hero

This is to say that

_____

showed managing anger, just like Etoo.

_____ _____

Signed Date

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